

Bowen Yang

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Research Interests

Algebra and mathematical physics, particularly commutative algebra in exactly solvable quantum lattice models. Homotopy-theoretic structure of quantum cellular automata and topological phases of matter. Mathematics of error-correcting codes.

Employment

Postdoctoral Fellow, Harvard University	2024–present
Lecturer, Department of Mathematics, Harvard University	Spring 2027
Teaching Fellow, Department of Mathematics, Harvard University	Spring 2026

Grants and Awards

AMS-Simons Travel Grant, American Mathematical Society	2026–2028
Scott Russell Johnson Graduate Dissertation Prize, Caltech	2023
Rufus B. Kellogg Graduate Fellowship (\$30,000 per annum)	2018–2021
Amherst International Student Scholarship, Amherst College	2014–2018

Publications

Published and Accepted

1. A mathematical theory of topological invariants of quantum spin systems (with Adam Artymowicz, Anton Kapustin), **Commun. Amer. Math. Soc.** *accepted*, arXiv:2410.19287.
2. Transition between 2D Symmetry Protected Topological Phases on a Klein Bottle (with Vibhu Ravindran, Xie Chen), **Phys. Rev. B** (2026) arXiv:2510.00587.
3. Clifford quantum cellular automata from topological quantum field theories and invertible subalgebras (with Meng Sun, Zongyuan Wang, Nathanan Tantivasadakarn, Yu-An Chen), **PRX Quantum** (2026) arXiv:2509.07099.
4. Categorifying Clifford QCA, **Commun. Math. Phys.** (2026), arXiv:2504.14811.
5. Homological invariants of Pauli stabilizer codes (with Blazej Ruba), **Commun. Math. Phys.** (2024). arXiv:2204.06023

6. Spatial decay of Kubo’s canonical correlation functions, **Lett. Math. Phys.** (2021). arXiv:1912.10831
7. A classification of invertible phases of bosonic quantum lattice systems in one dimension (with Anton Kapustin, Nikita Sopenko), **J. Math. Phys.** (2021). arXiv:2012.15491
8. Toy Teichmüller spaces of real dimension 2: the pentagon and the punctured triangle (with Yudong Chen et al.), **Geom. Dedicata** (2018). arXiv:1704.04331
9. “Strange” combinatorial quantum modular forms (with Amanda Folsom et al.), **J. Number Theory** (2017).

Preprints

1. K-Theoretic Obstructions to Linearizing QCA Representations (with Mattie Ji), arXiv:2606.19657.
2. Resolving Spurious Topological Entanglement Entropy in Stabilizer Codes (with P. Han, Z. Liang, Y. Wang, Y. Gu, Y. Chen), arXiv:2604.24847.
3. The Classification of Pauli Stabilizer Codes: A Lattice and Continuum Treatise (with Matthew Yu), arXiv:2604.24847.
4. Quantum Cellular Automata: The Group, the Space, and the Spectrum (with Mattie Ji), arXiv:2602.16572.
5. Witt Groups and Bulk-Boundary Correspondence for Stabilizer States (with Blazej Ruba), arXiv:2509.10418.
6. Operator algebra and algorithmic construction of boundaries and defects in (2+1)D topological Pauli stabilizer codes (with Zijian Liang, Joseph T. Iosue, Yu-An Chen), arXiv:2410.11942 (2024).

Invited Talks since Fall 2024

- 2026, **Stanford University**, *Quantum Cellular Automata Workshop*
- 2026, **Massachusetts Institute of Technology**, *Infinite-Dimensional Algebra Seminar*
- 2026, **La Jolla Meeting**, *Simons Collaboration on Global Categorical Symmetries*
- 2025, **University of Colorado Boulder**, *Topology Seminar*
- 2025, **Harvard University**, *Freedman Seminar*
- 2025, **New York University**, *Simons Collaboration on Global Categorical Symmetries*
- 2025, **SLMath**, *Workshop on Infinite-Dimensional Division Algebras*
- 2025, **Massachusetts Institute of Technology**, *Algebraic Topology Seminar*
- 2025, **University of Pennsylvania**, *Mathematical Physics Seminar*
- 2025, **University of California, Davis**, *Lattice Seminar* (online)

- 2024, **Amherst College**, *Colloquium*
- 2024, **Institute for Advanced Study**, *CMP/QFT Group Meeting*

Education

Ph.D. in Mathematics, California Institute of Technology Advisor: Anton Kapustin	2018–2023
B.A. in Mathematics, <i>summa cum laude</i> , Amherst College	2014–2018
Visiting Master’s Student, New College, University of Oxford	2016–2017

Teaching Experience

Senior Thesis Advisor, Harvard University Student: Luke Zhu	Summer 2026–Spring 2027
Summer REU Mentor, Harvard University Student: Vincent Costa	Summer 2026
Instructor, Harvard University Math 21B — Linear Algebra and Ordinary Differential Equations	Spring 2026
Instructor, California Institute of Technology Math 8 — Calculus for Problem Solving	Fall 2021
Course Assistant, California Institute of Technology Math 2/102 — Differential Equations Math 3/103 — Introduction to Probability and Statistics Math 5/105a — Introduction to Abstract Algebra Math 5/105b — Introduction to Abstract Algebra Math 5/105c — Introduction to Abstract Algebra Math 110c — Harmonic Analysis Math 121a — Combinatorial Analysis Math 121b — Combinatorial Analysis Math 1c — Calculus Math 120a — Commutative Algebra	2018–2022 Fall 2018 Winter 2019 Fall 2019 Winter 2020 Spring 2019 Spring 2020 Winter 2021 Spring 2021 Spring 2022 Fall 2022
Teaching Assistant/ Math Fellow, Amherst College CS 101 — Python, Spring 2015 CS 121 — Java, Fall 2015 Math 350 — Groups, Rings, and Fields Math 450 — Measure Theory and Integration Math 355 — Introduction to Analysis Math 405 — Lie Algebras	2015–2018 Fall 2015 Spring 2016 Fall 2017 Fall 2017
Counselor, Ross Mathematics Program	Summers 2017, 2019

Professional Service

Referee for *Communications in Mathematical Physics*; *Quantum Computing Theory in Practice (QCTiP)*; *Qualitative Theory of Dynamical Systems*.